

The Vox-Style Explainer. *Prompt Pack.*

Eight prompts that turn one news story into a finished sixty-second motion-graphics explainer: paper-cutout collage, a documentary narrator, burned subtitles, one MP4 ready to post. Claude writes and fact-checks it, Higgsfield animates it, and the whole thing runs while you make coffee.

8

PROMPTS

60s

FINISHED VIDEO

~\$10

CREDITS PER EPISODE

1

FINAL MP4

BEFORE YOU START

Ten minutes of setup, once.

This is the system from the video. Each prompt tells Claude to research a story, write a six-block script, lock a visual style, animate six clips, narrate them, and assemble one finished MP4. Paste a prompt and walk away. Anything in [BRACKETS] is yours to change first.

- + **Claude with the Higgsfield connector turned on.** Works in Claude Code or at claude.ai. Higgsfield is what generates the images, the animation, and the voice. Budget roughly 200 to 250 credits per episode, about ten dollars.
- + **The Vox Motion Graphics skill, if you have it.** Drop the skill folder into `~/.claude/skills/` and Claude finds it automatically. Every prompt here works with or without it: the skill hands you the house styles for free, and the prompt carries the full recipe on its own.
- + **Paste one prompt whole.** Do not trim it. The length is what stops Claude guessing. Several minutes pass before anything appears, that is normal.

THE SECRET THESE PROMPTS CARRY

Six blocks and one object.

Every good explainer is the same shape: **six narration blocks of about ten seconds**, and **one physical object that carries the whole story**. A paper box that goes from sealed to broken to rebuilt. An oil barrel riding a paper tanker. A planet that learns to breathe. The object is what makes sixty seconds feel like a film instead of a slideshow, and it is the part almost everyone leaves out.

- + **Block 1 hooks, block 5 twists, block 6 pays off the object.** Blocks 2 through 4 carry the facts. Every prompt here enforces that shape, so the pacing is right before a single frame exists.
- + **The style key is the whole game.** One reference image, attached to every clip, is what makes six separate shots look like one show. Prompt 02 builds you a permanent one.
- + **If clips come back looking like six different videos**, reply: *"Regenerate every clip with the style key passed as an image reference, and keep the palette, texture and lighting identical across all six."*

One story in, one finished video out.

The one from the video. Run it first exactly as written, with any topic you like, before you customize anything else in this pack.

Build me a complete sixty-second Vox-style motion-graphics explainer video about [YOUR TOPIC]. Work autonomously end to end: research, script, style, clips, narration, assembly. Do not stop at a plan and do not hand me loose clips. The deliverable is ONE finished MP4 with narration, music, sound effects and burned-in subtitles.

STEP 1, RESEARCH: Search the web for the real facts on this story. Cross-check every number against at least two independent sources and list your sources at the end. If a number is disputed, use the conservative figure. Do not invent statistics, ever.

STEP 2, SCRIPT: Write exactly SIX narration blocks of roughly twenty words each, about ten seconds spoken. Block 1 is a hook built on the single most surprising real number in the story. Blocks 2, 3 and 4 carry the facts in escalating order. Block 5 is the twist, the thing that reverses what the viewer assumed. Block 6 lands the meaning and pays off the through-line object. Write for the EAR: short sentences, spell numbers as words, commas instead of periods where you want pace instead of a dramatic pause. No jargon, no throat-clearing, no "in today's video".

STEP 3, THE THROUGH-LINE OBJECT: Before generating anything, choose ONE physical paper object that appears in all six scenes and escalates each time. Tell me what it is in one line. Every scene description must feature it. This is what makes the video feel like one film.

STEP 4, STYLE KEY: Generate ONE 16:9 reference image with the best available image model: "Flat-lay style reference sheet photographed from directly above, paper cut-out collage on warm cream cardstock, torn kraft paper edges, halftone dot texture, hand-drawn ink circles and underlines, muted sepia and brick-red and ink-navy palette, editorial magazine illustration, no text, no watermark." Show it to me, then attach this SAME image as an image reference on EVERY clip you generate. This is what locks the look.

STEP 5, CLIPS: Generate six 10-second 16:9 clips, one per narration block, with the best available image-to-video model. Each scene is paper cut-outs moving on the cream background with snappy camera pushes, hand-cut arrows, growing paper bar charts and maps. Rules that matter: a MAXIMUM of three text elements per scene and a maximum of four words in any title, or the model will duplicate or garble the words. Add the negative prompt "repeated text, doubled text, two lines of identical text, dark background, photorealistic, live action, human faces". Never a filmed scene, always a motion-designed magazine spread.

STEP 6, NARRATION: Generate the six narration lines with a warm documentary narrator voice. Target 9 to 10.5 seconds per line. If a take runs long, raise the speech rate and shorten the line rather than cutting the clip. Trim any leading or trailing silence off every audio file before you use it.

STEP 7, ASSEMBLE: Cut the six clips in order, place each narration line about 0.4 seconds after its cut so the visual lands first, leave natural half-second gaps between lines, add a music bed at low volume ducked under the voice, keep the clips' own sound effects quiet underneath, and burn in subtitles in a bold condensed sans. Export 1080p MP4.

VERIFY: Before you call it done, extract a frame from each of the six clips and check that the style matches across all of them, that no text is duplicated or misspelled, and that the through-line object appears in every scene. Fix anything broken and re-render. Then give me the file path, the runtime, the credits spent, and your source list.

Build a style key you keep forever.

Run this once. The image it produces is what makes every future episode look like the same show, and it costs a few cents instead of a rebrand.

I am starting a motion-graphics explainer series and I need a permanent visual identity. Build me a **STYLE KEY**: one reference image that I will attach to every clip of every future episode so the whole series looks like one show.

MY SERIES: topic area is [WHAT YOUR VIDEOS ARE ABOUT, e.g. AI news, personal finance, geopolitics]. The feeling I want is [PICK: bright and playful editorial / dark and cinematic / warm and archival / neon and technical]. My brand colors, if any: [YOUR COLORS, or say "you choose"].

STEP 1: Propose **THREE** different visual directions in words before generating anything. For each one give me the background material, the palette in three to four named colors, the texture, and one line on why it fits my topic. Number them and stop for my pick.

STEP 2, once I choose: Generate the style key as a 16:9 image with the best available image model, composed as a flat-lay reference sheet photographed from directly above. It must contain the recurring **PROP VOCABULARY** of my series as paper cut-outs laid out on the background material, so future clips have something to copy: [LIST 6 TO 8 THINGS THAT WILL RECUR, e.g. a robot, a lightning bolt, a server rack, a coin stack, a stopwatch, a document, a chart, a globe]. Include a small swatch strip of the palette in one corner. Absolutely no text and no watermark anywhere in the image.

STEP 3: Show it to me. If I say it is not right, regenerate with my note, do not defend the first one. When I approve it, save the image locally, tell me the exact file path and the generation job ID, and write me a short **STYLE BIBLE** in plain text I can paste into future prompts: the background material, the palette hex codes, the texture rules, the lighting, the camera behaviour, and the negative prompt to use every time.

STEP 4: Prove it works. Generate **ONE** test 10-second clip using this style key as an image reference, showing [ONE SIMPLE SCENE FROM YOUR TOPIC]. Extract three frames and show me, so I can confirm the style holds under animation before I commit to a whole episode.

Rules: the style key must be reusable for hundreds of clips, so keep it generic enough to cover any story in my topic area but specific enough that the palette and texture are unmistakable. Avoid anything trendy that will look dated in six months. No faces, no logos, no real brands.

The paper-diorama documentary.

Same six-block engine, completely different feeling: sepia newsprint worlds you fly through, letterpress labels on real props. Built for money, power and conflict stories.

Build me a sixty-second PAPER-DIORAMA DOCUMENTARY explainer about [YOUR TOPIC]. This is not the flat collage look. This is a cinematic miniature world made of newsprint and cardboard, filmed as one continuous flight. Work autonomously end to end and deliver ONE finished MP4 with narration, sound and burned-in subtitles.

THE LOOK: tiny handmade dioramas built from aged sepia newsprint, corrugated cardboard and torn paper, lit like a film set with hard directional light and deep shadows. Everything is monochrome newsprint EXCEPT one single accent color, burnt orange, which appears only on the object that matters in each scene. Figures are faceless paper cut-outs with censor bars where faces would be. All labels are letterpress-printed ON physical props, a paper sign, a stamped crate, a banner, never floating text.

THE CAMERA: every clip is a fake one-take. One continuous first-person flight through the diorama, starting and ending in motion blur so the six clips cut together as if it never stopped moving. Fly through doorways, under bridges, between buildings. Never a static shot.

STEP 1, RESEARCH: Search the web and cross-check every fact against at least two sources. List sources at the end. Conservative figures only, no invented numbers.

STEP 2, SCRIPT: Six narration blocks, about twenty words each, ten seconds spoken. Block 1 hook on the biggest real number, blocks 2 to 4 escalate, block 5 is the twist, block 6 lands the meaning. Write for the ear. Then choose ONE burnt-orange object that rides through all six dioramas and escalates each time, and tell me what it is.

STEP 3, LABELS: Write six short labels, one per scene, maximum three words each, that will be letterpress-printed on a prop inside the shot. The last one should be the question or phrase the whole video is built around.

STEP 4, STYLE KEY: Generate one 16:9 reference image: "Miniature paper diorama built from aged sepia newsprint and torn cardboard, photographed with hard cinematic side lighting and deep shadows, monochrome newsprint tones with a single burnt orange paper accent, faceless paper cut-out figures with black censor bars, tilt-shift miniature depth of field, no text, no watermark." Attach this same image as a reference on all six clips.

STEP 5, CLIPS: Six 10-second 16:9 clips, one per block, each a continuous flight through that scene's diorama, each featuring the through-line object and that scene's letterpress label on a prop. Negative prompt: "floating text, subtitles, watermark, photorealistic humans, faces, color photography, bright saturated colors".

STEP 6, NARRATION: A deep, measured documentary narrator, the kind that reads a war report. Target 9 to 10.5 seconds per line. Trim silence off every take.

STEP 7, ASSEMBLE: Cut in order, narration 0.4 seconds after each cut, tense low music bed ducked under the voice, keep the clips' own ambience quiet underneath, burn in subtitles in a bold condensed sans. Export 1080p.

VERIFY: extract a frame from each clip, confirm every scene reads as newsprint with exactly one orange accent, confirm each label rendered correctly on a prop and is not misspelled, confirm the through-line object appears six times. Fix and re-render before delivering.

The news radar.

For the days you have nothing. Claude finds today's most explainable story in your niche, pitches you three, and builds the winner the moment you pick.

I want to publish a Vox-style explainer today and I do not have a topic. Find me one, then build it. My niche is [YOUR NICHE]. My audience is [WHO WATCHES YOU]. My angle is always [YOUR ANGLE, e.g. what it means for regular people / follow the money / what nobody is telling you].

STEP 1, SCAN: Search the web for stories in my niche from the last seven days. You are looking for stories that satisfy ALL FOUR of these tests, because these are what make a story explainable in sixty seconds: (1) there is one hard NUMBER that is genuinely surprising, (2) there is a TWIST, the obvious interpretation is wrong, (3) it can be shown with OBJECTS rather than talking heads, and (4) it actually matters to my audience's money, safety or work. Reject anything that fails one of the four, no matter how big the headline is.

STEP 2, PITCH: Give me exactly THREE candidates. For each one, in no more than six lines: the headline in plain words, the surprising number, the twist in one sentence, the through-line object you would use, and a one-line score out of ten for how well it will perform. Rank them and tell me which one you would pick and why. Then STOP and wait for me to choose.

STEP 3, VERIFY BEFORE YOU BUILD: Once I pick, cross-check every fact in that story against at least two independent, named sources. If the central number does not hold up, say so immediately and offer me the runner-up instead of building on a shaky fact. Reputation is worth more than an episode.

STEP 4, BUILD: Now produce the complete sixty-second explainer end to end, following the standard recipe: six narration blocks of about twenty words, hook then escalation then twist then meaning, one through-line paper object in every scene, one style key image attached as a reference to all six clips, six 10-second clips at a maximum of three text elements each, documentary narration at 9 to 10.5 seconds per line with silence trimmed, local assembly with narration 0.4 seconds after each cut, music ducked under the voice, subtitles burned in. Deliver ONE finished MP4.

STEP 5, PACKAGE IT: With the video, give me three title options, a caption written in plain conversational language with no em dashes and no mention of AI, five hashtags, and the source list so I can defend every number if someone asks.

Narrate it yourself, without recording.

A cloned voice turns a generic explainer into YOUR show. This is the single biggest jump in perceived quality in the whole pack.

I want my explainer series narrated in MY OWN voice. Set up the voice clone first, then use it to build a full episode about [YOUR TOPIC].

STEP 1, THE CLONE: Walk me through creating a voice clone with the Higgsfield connector. Tell me exactly what audio sample you need from me: how long, what to say, what to avoid, and what recording conditions matter. Wait for me to provide it. Once the voice exists, save the voice ID and repeat it back to me in plain text so I never lose it.

STEP 2, CALIBRATE, do not skip this: Before building anything, generate ONE test line of about twenty words in my cloned voice and measure how many seconds it runs. Cloned voices almost always read slower than you expect, which is what wrecks the timing of a whole episode. Report the seconds and the words per second. Then tell me the exact speech rate setting and target word count per line that lands a block between 9 and 10.5 seconds, and use those numbers for every line from here on.

STEP 3, WRITE FOR MY MOUTH: Write the six narration blocks using the word count you just calculated. Use commas where you want pace and periods only where you genuinely want a dramatic pause, because periods create long gaps in synthesized speech. Read each line back and cut any word that a real person would not say out loud.

STEP 4, CLEAN EVERY TAKE: After generating each narration line, check for silence at the start and end of the audio and trim it off before use. A single take with four seconds of dead air at the front will bury the hook and it is invisible until you watch the final cut.

STEP 5, BUILD: Produce the full sixty-second explainer with the standard recipe: research and cross-check facts against two sources, one through-line paper object in all six scenes, one style key image attached as a reference to every clip, six 10-second clips with a maximum of three text elements each, assembly with narration 0.4 seconds after each cut, music ducked under the voice, subtitles burned in.

STEP 6, MIX FOR VOICE: My voice is the star, so mix it forward and everything else back. Bring the narration up until it clearly sits on top, keep the music quiet enough that it never competes, keep the clips' sound effects lower still, and put a limiter on the final mix so nothing clips. Tell me the levels you used so I can reuse them next time.

Deliver ONE finished MP4 plus the voice ID, the speech rate, the target word count, and the mix levels written out, so episode two takes half the time.

Explain your own business.

Same machine, pointed at your product instead of the news. This is the version you can sell to clients, and the version that sells you.

Build me a sixty-second Vox-style explainer about MY business, the kind that makes a stranger understand what I do and want it. Work end to end and deliver ONE finished MP4.

MY BUSINESS: [WHAT YOU DO, ONE LINE]. WHO IT IS FOR: [YOUR CUSTOMER]. THE PROBLEM THEY HAVE: [THE PAIN, IN THEIR WORDS]. WHAT I ACTUALLY DELIVER: [YOUR OFFER]. PROOF I CAN BACK UP: [REAL NUMBERS, RESULTS OR TIMEFRAMES]. WHAT I WANT THEM TO DO: [YOUR CALL TO ACTION].

STEP 1, FIND THE STORY, do not skip to the script: Explainers sell because they explain a PROBLEM, not a product. Before writing anything, tell me in five lines what the real, specific, expensive problem is that my customer lives with, why the usual solutions fail them, and what the one surprising truth is that reframes it. If what I gave you is too vague to build on, ask me up to three sharp questions and wait.

STEP 2, SCRIPT: Six blocks of about twenty words. Block 1 opens on the PROBLEM at its most painful, with a real number if I gave you one. Block 2 shows what it costs them to keep living with it. Block 3 is the reframe, the surprising truth. Block 4 is how the fix actually works, in plain language, no feature lists. Block 5 is proof, using only numbers I gave you, never invented ones. Block 6 is the call to action, one clear instruction. Never say the words "solution", "innovative", "seamless", "leverage" or "revolutionize".

STEP 3, THE OBJECT: Choose ONE paper object that represents my customer's problem and physically transforms across the six scenes: tangled to straight, heavy to light, scattered to stacked, closed to open. Tell me what it is before you generate anything.

STEP 4, STYLE: Generate one 16:9 style key as a flat-lay paper cut-out reference sheet using MY brand colors [YOUR COLORS, or say "pick something that fits my industry"], and attach it as an image reference on all six clips so the video looks like it belongs to my brand.

STEP 5, CLIPS AND VOICE: Six 10-second 16:9 clips, one per block, featuring the transforming object, maximum three text elements per scene and four words per title. Narration in a warm, credible, non-salesy voice at 9 to 10.5 seconds per line, silence trimmed off every take.

STEP 6, ASSEMBLE AND DELIVER: Cut in order, narration 0.4 seconds after each cut, music ducked under the voice, subtitles burned in, 1080p. Then give me the same video reframed to vertical 9:16 for reels and shorts, plus three caption options and a version of the script I can read on camera myself.

Turn one video into a series.

One video is a post. A series is a channel. This builds the bible and the first month of episodes so you never start from a blank page again.

I have made one Vox-style explainer and I want to turn it into a real series. Build me the system, not another one-off. My niche is [YOUR NICHE]. My audience is [WHO WATCHES]. I can publish [HOW OFTEN]. My style key, if I have one, is at [FILE PATH, or say "build me one"].

STEP 1, THE SERIES BIBLE: Write me a one-page bible in plain text covering: the series name and what it promises in one sentence, the ONE question every episode answers, the visual rules that never change (background, palette, texture, camera behaviour, negative prompt), the narration rules (voice, pace, target seconds per block, words per line), the structural rules (six blocks, hook, escalation, twist, meaning, through-line object), and the three things that are allowed to change episode to episode. This document is the thing that makes episode twenty look like episode one.

STEP 2, THE OPEN AND CLOSE: Design a two-second title treatment and a three-second end card that appear in every episode, described precisely enough that I can regenerate them identically forever. Consistent bookends are the cheapest way to feel like a real show.

STEP 3, THE SLATE: Search the web for what is actually happening in my niche right now and pitch me [NUMBER] episodes, enough for one month. For each: working title, the surprising number it hangs on, the twist, the through-line object, and a score out of ten. Rank them by how well they will perform, and mark which one should go first and why. Kill any idea that has no hard number or no twist, and say so.

STEP 4, THE PRODUCTION CHECKLIST: Write me a numbered checklist of every step to produce one episode, with the exact settings that worked, so I or an assistant can run it without thinking. Include the failure points and the fix for each: style drift, duplicated text in clips, narration running long, silence at the head of a take, generation jobs that hang.

STEP 5, BUILD EPISODE ONE: Now produce the top-ranked episode as a complete finished MP4 using the bible you just wrote. Follow the recipe exactly: cross-checked facts with named sources, six blocks, through-line object in every scene, style key attached to every clip, narration timed and silence-trimmed, assembled with the narration 0.4 seconds after each cut, music ducked, subtitles burned in.

Deliver: the bible, the slate, the checklist, and episode one as a finished video with its source list.

Fix the pacing nobody else fixes.

This is the difference between a video that feels AI-made and one that does not. Run it on any explainer, from this pack or anywhere else, that feels slightly off.

I have an explainer video that feels stiff and I cannot tell why. The clips are at [PATH TO YOUR CLIPS] and the narration files are at [PATH TO YOUR AUDIO]. Re-assemble it properly and tell me what was wrong.

THE DIAGNOSIS FIRST: Before touching anything, measure and report: the exact duration of every clip, the exact duration of every narration take, how much silence sits at the head and tail of each take, and where each narration line currently starts relative to its cut. Nine times out of ten the problem is one of four things and I want you to name which: (1) each narration line is centered inside a fixed ten-second window, which creates dead air at both ends of every single block, (2) takes have baked-in silence at the front that buries the first words, (3) the narration starts at the exact instant of the cut so the viewer never gets to see the shot, or (4) the music is one flat loop with no arc, which makes sixty seconds feel like three minutes.

NOW FIX IT, in this order:

1. SILENCE: Strip leading and trailing silence off every narration file. Do this before anything else, because every timing decision downstream depends on the real start of the words.
2. PLACEMENT: Place each narration line about 0.4 seconds AFTER its cut, not on it. The viewer needs a beat to read the new image before a voice starts. Leave natural gaps of half a second to a second and a half between lines. Do not stretch or squeeze audio to fill a window, let the gaps be uneven, that is what real editing sounds like.
3. CLIP LENGTH FOLLOWS AUDIO: If a narration line is shorter than its clip, trim the clip. If it is longer, hold the last frame briefly rather than rushing the read. The picture serves the voice, never the reverse.
4. MUSIC ARC: Do not use one loop. Use an energetic bed for the opening third, a softer bed under the middle where the facts land, then return to the energetic bed for the payoff, crossfaded between sections and loudness-matched so the switch is invisible. Duck the music under the voice.
5. MIX: Voice clearly on top, music well underneath, the clips' own sound effects lower still, and a limiter on the master so nothing clips. Report the exact levels you used.
6. SUBTITLES: Burn them in, bold condensed sans, high contrast, no more than two lines at a time, timed to the trimmed audio and not the original.

Then export 1080p, and give me a short before-and-after: what the total dead air was before, what it is now, and what you changed. If nothing was wrong, say so plainly instead of making changes to look busy.

THE RULES THAT MAKE THIS WORK

Everything I got wrong first, so you do not have to.

- + **Three text elements per scene. Four words per title. Hard limits.** Push past them and the model duplicates words, renders the same line twice, or invents spelling. This is the single most common failure and it is entirely avoidable.

- + **The style key goes on every clip, every time.** Six clips generated without a shared reference image will look like six different videos. One reference image is the whole difference between a series and a pile of clips.

- + **Verify frames before you assemble.** Pull one frame out of each clip and actually look at it. Finding a garbled title after the final render costs you the whole assembly step twice.

- + **Trim the silence off every narration take.** Synthesized voices routinely come back with seconds of dead air at the front. It will bury your hook and you will not notice until the video feels slow and you cannot say why.

- + **Narration lands after the cut, not on it.** Four tenths of a second. It sounds like nothing written down and it is the difference between amateur and professional on playback.

- + **Write for the ear, not the page.** Twenty words a line. Numbers spelled out. Commas for pace, periods for drama. If you would not say it out loud to a friend, cut it.

- + **Never invent a number.** Make Claude name two sources for every figure. One fabricated statistic in a video that looks this credible costs more than every video you have made.

- + **If a generation job hangs for half an hour,** submit a duplicate and race them. Farms wedge sometimes. Waiting politely is not a strategy.

THE UPGRADE

This pack drives it by hand. *Members do it in one command.*

Inside AI Workshop, the explainer skill runs this entire pipeline from a single line: research, script, style key, clips, voice, mix, subtitles, final MP4. It ships alongside 200+ Claude Code skills, the AI employees (JARVIS, TARS, SPARK, BLAKE), every install guide, and every future drop the moment it lands. **The skills are not for sale anywhere. Members get everything.**

👉 [*skool.com/aiworkshop*](https://skool.com/aiworkshop)

Built with Claude Code + Higgsfield · Post your first episode in the community, the best one gets featured.